

Addon Name: Storyboard Suite (Definitive Build)

Blender Version: 4.2+

Purpose: A professional storyboard and pre-visualization tool that keeps each scene isolated in its own collection while allowing objects (characters, props) to persist across scenes via UUIDs.

Getting Started

1. **Enable the Add-on**
 - Edit → Preferences → Add-ons → Search “Storyboard” → Enable “Storyboard Suite”.
2. **Open the Panel**
 - In the 3D Viewport, press **N** to open the sidebar.
 - Go to the **Storyboard** tab (it will appear after enabling).

Creating Scenes

- In the **Creation & Navigation** section:
 - Click **Create New Scene** → adds a new empty scene with a camera and key light.
 - New scenes are automatically numbered: Storyboard_Scene_001, 002, etc.
 - The view switches to the new scene and looks through the camera.
- Optional tools:
 - **Add Camera From View** – adds a new camera matched to your current 3D view.
 - **Add Light** – adds a point light at the 3D cursor location.

Navigating Scenes

- **Previous Scene / Next Scene** buttons – move sequentially through scenes.
- Only the active scene is visible; all others are hidden in the viewport.

Working with Objects (Characters, Props)

1. **Assign UUID** (important!)
 - Select an object → in **Active Object (UUID)** panel → click **Assign UUID**.
 - This allows the object to be “held” across scenes.
2. **Holding / Propagating Objects**
 - **Hold Forward** – duplicates the selected object into all later scenes.
 - **Hold Backward** – duplicates into all earlier scenes.
 - **Propagate to Selected** – duplicates into manually selected scenes (checkboxes in Propagation panel).
3. **Syncing Changes**
 - After holding an object across scenes, select it in any scene → click **Sync Transforms**.

- Position, rotation, and scale changes will update in all other scenes that share the same UUID.
4. **Making an Object Unique**
- If you want an object to diverge in one scene → click **Make Unique (Fork UUID)**.
 - It gets a new UUID and will no longer sync with the others.

Reordering Scenes

- In the **Creation & Navigation** section:
 - **Up Arrow / Down Arrow** buttons – move the current scene up or down in the sequence.
 - All scenes are automatically renumbered (001, 002, ...).
 - Thumbnails are updated.
- If things get messy (e.g., names like 004.001), click **Force Cleanup & Renumber** (in Danger Zone or wherever you placed it) to fix everything.

Thumbnails

- **Thumbnail Browser** panel shows a preview of each scene from its camera.
- Click **Refresh** next to a thumbnail to update it (useful after moving the camera).
- **Generate All Thumbnails** – re-renders all.
- **Clear Thumbnail Cache** – deletes all thumbnails (useful if files get corrupted).

Scene Notes & Metadata

- In **Scene Review** panel:
 - Click on a scene entry to activate it.
 - Edit **Title, Duration, Camera Move, Dialogue, Notes** directly.
 - Lock a scene with the padlock icon to prevent accidental edits.
- **Export Metadata** (Data Management panel):
 - Creates a text and CSV file in `//storyboard_exports/` with all scene notes and total runtime.

Director Safe Mode

- Toggle **Director Safe Mode** (top of Scene Review panel).
- Locks all editing of notes and prevents accidental changes – perfect when showing to others.

Danger Zone

- **Delete Active Scene** – deletes the current scene (confirmation required).
- **Force Cleanup & Renumber** – fixes any naming issues and refreshes everything.

Tips & Best Practices

- Always **Assign UUID** to important objects before holding them forward/backward.
- Use **Sync Transforms** whenever you pose or move a character that should stay consistent.
- Use **Make Unique** when a pose or position should only exist in one scene.
- Save your .blend file in a normal folder (Documents, etc.) so thumbnails can be written properly.
- If navigation feels jumpy, run **Force Cleanup & Renumber**.

Enjoy storyboarding! This tool is designed to keep your workflow fast and organized while giving full control over what carries forward between shots.

— Dustin & Grok (2025)